

Final Thoughts

I know personal finance is not the most exciting topic for young adults. I spent my late teens and early twenties without knowing or caring about any of the things in this book. I bought things without thinking, traveled extensively, lived in foreign countries, and never once budgeted for my future. I would not trade my experiences for anything, but my lack of real-world financial knowledge set me back. And, most importantly, I could have done all the things I did when I was younger while simultaneously managing my finances and preparing for my future.

When I decided it was time to be an adult and take control of my finances, I had to drastically change my spending and living habits. It took me years to pay down my debt and get onto a path toward financial freedom. Because I waited so long to learn these things, for a few years I had to choose between financial responsibility and what I considered fun. If you start early, you may never have to make this choice. If you are mindful of your money habits and make informed financial decisions while you are young, you will not need to make the drastic sacrifices I did.

I hope you can take the lessons, examples, and anecdotes from this book and avoid the mistakes I made. Please do not wait